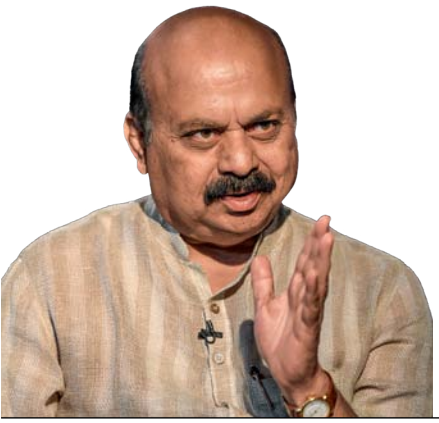
sentence: If the rule of law to be followed is Hindutva, I don't mind it.

Q. The BJP has talked of dynasty-*mukt* Bharat. In some senses, you are a dynast too.
There is a lot of difference. First, my father was no more there when I joined the BJP. Then I built my own political career and not because I was the son of a politician. And I have never used the family name in other things. So, on my own hard work, people have recognised me and that is recognised by the BJP.



"BENGALURU'S PROBLEMS NEED A PERMANENT SOLUTION AND WE ARE SETTING UP FOUR SATELLITE TOWNS TO EASE THE PRESSURE"

Q. What about former chief minister B.S. Yediyurappa who has said he wants his son to become an MLA too?
Yediyurappa is a person who has dedicated his life to the BJP for the past 40 years. He is representing Shikaripura for the seventh or eighth time now and he has decided not to contest again. Since he is retiring and the people of that constituency want his son to stand, he had suggested it. Now the party high command will take a decision on this.

Q. When it comes to the industrial development of the state, what have you done to boost it?
To meet the present challenges, the ease of doing business was necessary, so we have taken a series of measures where we have made procedures so much easier that anybody who wants to set up a shop will not face harassment. We also have sector-specific policies. In major thrust areas, we have given much more production-linked incentives or PLIs than other states have given. We are going to have the first semi-conductor plant if the Centre approves, and we are also setting up a cluster for FMCG. Apart from these, we are carving out special investment regions, funding startups. We are the first state to have an R&D policy—from garage to institution, from genomics to space, encouraging youngsters to go into different fields of startups. Now we have R&D; Karnataka is the first state in the country to have an R&D policy. All this will make Karnataka the future economic engine of our country.

Q. Bengaluru's infrastructure is in a bad state and even Telangana minister K.T. Rama Rao invited investors to come to Hyderabad instead...
Bengaluru is not competing with any other city in the country. Our competition is with Silicon Valley. Our strength is the ecosystem that really helps entrepreneurs, the technological hub, a large pool of technically talented people and the ease of doing business. Now 38 per cent of the country's FDI is coming to Karnataka. As regards infrastructure, there is no doubt that there is a problem. To end traffic jams, we are widening the roads and creating a dozen corridors that would have seamless signals. But there is a need for a permanent solution. I am putting together a plan where we will have four satellite towns set up with rail and road links to the city. It will be a beautiful, very well-planned Greater Bengaluru that we are planning to develop.

Q. Whenever you come to Delhi, there is talk of you getting sanction for your cabinet expansion. Is it going to happen?
We are going to expand the cabinet. When and how, the BJP central leaders will decide. When they do, I will let you know.

Q. With the state assembly election due in May 2023, what are you planning to focus on in the remaining year that you have and are you confident of bringing the BJP back to power again?
My priority is to implement my budget, which has been accepted very well. The second is to bring about a lot of changes in the government that will ensure quick redressal of people's problems with time-bound action to provide good governance. Third, giving a sense of confidence to all sections of society that this government is for them and is going to take care of them, including youngsters, farmers and women who are our driving economic force, to help them to such an extent that they will lead a life of *swabhimaani* (self-respect). Poverty doesn't have any caste. I am putting all my strength, my time and energy for the upliftment of those at the bottom of the pyramid and my conviction is that it is going to make a difference. As regards the election, getting 150 seats is the target given by Amit Shah*ji* and we are going to strive to get 150-plus. ■